SPACE TO ORGANIZE

Dorm Move-In Planner

A practical setup guide for students moving into a small room

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Print it, fill it in, and use it at your own pace. This guide helps you make thoughtful choices before spending money or changing your space.

1. Your room at a glance

Fill in what you know before shopping. Check what your residence supplies and measure the room where possible.

Room detail	Your notes
Residence / building	_____
Room / bed number	_____
Move-in date	_____
Room length × width	_____
Bed size / type	_____
Roommate / shared items	_____

Measure before you buy

Measure	Dimensions / notes
Bed and clearance	_____
Desk and chair footprint	_____
Wardrobe / dresser	_____
Door swing and entry path	_____
Window, outlets, vents	_____
Under-bed clearance	_____

2. Room layout planner

Sketch your room below. Mark the door, windows, outlets, fixed furniture, and walking paths. Keep exits and access points clear.

Layout decisions

- ■ I left a clear route from the door to the bed.
- ■ Frequently used items are easy to reach.
- ■ The desk has suitable light and outlet access.
- ■ Storage does not block doors, windows, vents, or safety equipment.
- ■ I checked residence rules before planning wall hooks or lighting.

My top three layout priorities:

1.	_____
2.	_____
3.	_____

3. Essentials checklist

Check what you already own first. Confirm what your residence supplies and what is allowed.

Bedding & sleep

- ■ Sheets that fit the bed
- ■ Pillow and pillowcase
- ■ Comforter / duvet
- ■ Mattress protector, if needed
- ■ Laundry bag

Study & daily use

- ■ Laptop and chargers
- ■ Desk supplies
- ■ Headphones
- ■ Reusable water bottle
- ■ Desk lamp, if allowed

Bathroom & personal care

- ■ Towels and washcloth
- ■ Shower shoes, if needed
- ■ Toiletries
- ■ Shower caddy, if needed
- ■ Basic first-aid items

Cleaning & laundry

- ■ Laundry detergent
- ■ Laundry basket or bag
- ■ Cleaning cloths
- ■ Trash bags
- ■ Room-safe cleaning supplies

Organization

- ■ Hangers
- ■ Small bins or drawer dividers
- ■ Under-bed containers that fit
- ■ Permitted hooks or organizers
- ■ Labels or marker

Documents & practicals

- ■ ID and housing documents
- ■ Keys / access card

- Emergency contacts
- Essential personal items
- Move-in condition photos

4. Storage plan

Give each category a home. Start with what you own; buy containers only after measuring the space.

Category	Where it will live	What I still need
Clothes	_____	_____
Shoes	_____	_____
Study supplies	_____	_____
Bathroom items	_____	_____
Snacks / dishes	_____	_____
Laundry / cleaning	_____	_____
Seasonal / extras	_____	_____

Shared-room agreement

- ■ We agreed which items are shared and which are personal.
- ■ We chose where cleaning supplies and trash bags go.
- ■ We discussed quiet hours, guests, lights, and desk use.
- ■ We agreed to keep entry and walking paths clear.

Roommate notes / agreements:

_____
_____
_____

5. Move-in day checklist

Work through these tasks in order to make the first day calmer.

Before leaving home

- ■ Confirm move-in time and check-in instructions.
- ■ Pack documents, keys, medication, and chargers separately.
- ■ Label bags or boxes by category.
- ■ Keep a first-night bag easy to reach.

When you arrive

- ■ Photograph existing marks or damage and report them as required.
- ■ Check bed, desk, storage, outlets, and lights.
- ■ Make the bed and unpack the first-night bag.
- ■ Set up chargers and study essentials.
- ■ Put toiletries and laundry supplies away.
- ■ Remove packaging according to residence rules.

Before the first night

- ■ Check locks and emergency exits.
- ■ Set an alarm and save important contact details.
- ■ Write down anything missing instead of panic-buying.
- ■ Keep walking paths clear.

Things to follow up on:

Task	When / who
_____	_____
_____	_____
_____	_____

6. Budget tracker

Set a spending limit before shopping. Prices vary, so enter your own estimates and actual costs.

Item / category	Estimated cost	Actual cost	Bought?
Bedding	_____	_____	■
Laundry	_____	_____	■
Study supplies	_____	_____	■
Bathroom	_____	_____	■
Storage	_____	_____	■
Cleaning	_____	_____	■
Other	_____	_____	■
Other	_____	_____	■
TOTAL	_____	_____	

My spending limit: _____ Amount left: _____

Before you buy

- ■ I checked whether the item is already supplied.
- ■ I measured the space and checked product dimensions.
- ■ I checked residence rules and return policies.
- ■ I compared a low-cost option with a durable option.
- ■ I know where the item will be stored.

Small-space reminder: Start with essentials, measure first, and let the room show you what you need after you arrive. You do not need to buy everything on day one.